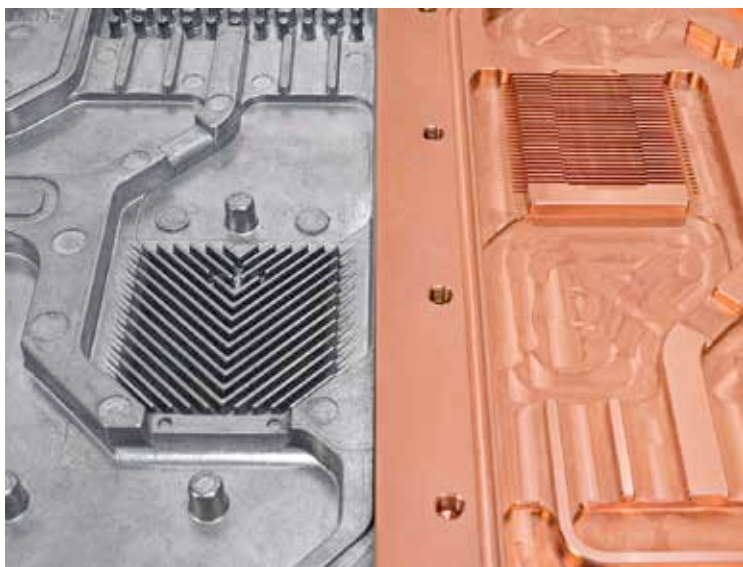


to be copper-based. Nickel-plated ones are also copper-based but they are given a nickel coating to prevent corrosion and wear over time. They are comparatively more expensive as well. Aluminium-based water blocks are also available nowadays that are more affordable. There won't be much of a performance difference between copper and nickel-plated blocks. When it comes to choosing between copper and aluminium, you will achieve slightly better cooling with copper. While considering the blocks, all you need to remember is not to mix different metals in the system. Using different metals in the loop will lead to galvanic corrosion and mess up your cooling system.



Copper water blocks are more expensive than aluminium water blocks

Reservoirs

A reservoir is usually a cylinder where the excess coolant is stored. While the cooling system is circulating the fluid across the components, it tends to evaporate. This is where it will get its reserve coolant. It also makes the process of filling and draining the loop way easier. They are found in varying sizes of cylinders that can be attached vertically or horizontally inside the case. By looking at the length and diameter of the reservoir, you will be able to determine whether it will fit in your case. Since horizontal placement usually takes a lot of space, vertically mounted cylinder reservoirs should